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Background

*I have been captured
by the Empire and
sentenced to death
alongside the
Stormcloak rebels. We
were taken to Helgen,
but before I could be
executed a dragon
appeared and
attacked the town. I
need to find some way
to escape.*

Objectives

1. Make your way to the keep
2. Enter the Keep with Hadvar or Ralof
3. Escape Helgen
4. Find some equipment (*Hadvar*)
5. Loot Gunjar's body (*Ralof*)
6. Search the barrel for potions (*optional*)
7. Attempt to pick the lock of the cage (*optional*)

Walkthrough

Upon starting a new game, the Dragonborn will awaken, hands bound, aboard a cart with three others, drawn by Imperial soldiers. The cart will progress to the town of Helgen where the **Stormcloaks**, **Lokir**, and the Dragonborn will be lead to their public execution.

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nice and lazy. If they hadn't been looking for you, I could've stolen that horse and been halfway to Hammerfell. You there... You and me, we shouldn't be here. It's these Stormcloaks the Empire wants." **Ralof**: "We're all brothers and sisters in binds now, thief." **Imperial Soldier**: "Shut up back there!" **Lokir**: "And what's wrong with him, huh?" **Ralof**: "Watch your tongue. You're speaking to Ulfric Stormcloak, the true High King." **Lokir**: "Ulfric? The Jarl of Windhelm? You're the leader of the rebellion. But if they've captured you... Oh gods, where are they taking us?" **Ralof**: "I don't know where we're going, but Sovngarde awaits." **Lokir**: "No, this can't be happening. This isn't happening." **Ralof**: "Hey, what village are you from, horse thief?" **Lokir**: "Why do you care?" **Ralof**: "A Nord's last thoughts should be of home." **Lokir**: "Rorikstead. I'm... I'm from Rorikstead." **Imperial**: "General Tullius, sir! The headsman is waiting!" **Tullius**: "Good. Let's get this over with." **Lokir**: "Shor, Mara, Dibella, Kynareth, Akatosh. Divines, please help me." **Ralof**: "Look at him, General Tullius, the Military Governor. And it looks like the Thalmor are with him. Damn elves. I bet they had something to do with this. This is Helgen. I used to be sweet on a girl from here. Wonder if Vilod is still making that mead with juniper berries mixed in. Funny, when I was a boy, Imperial walls and towers used to make me feel so safe." **Haming**: "Who are they, daddy? Where are they going?" **Torolf**: "You need to go inside, little cub." **Haming**: "Why? I want to watch the soldiers." **Torolf**: "Inside the house. Now." **Haming**: "Yes, papa." **Imperial**: "Whoa!" **Captain**: "Get these prisoners out of the carts. Move it!" **Lokir**: "Why are we stopping?" **Ralof**: "Why do you think? End of the line. Let's go. Shouldn't keep the gods waiting for us." **Lokir**: "No! Wait! We're not rebels!" **Ralof**: "Face your death with some courage, thief." **Lokir**: "You've got to tell them! We weren't with you! This is a mistake!" **Imperial Captain**: "Step towards the block when we call your name. One at a time." **Ralof**: "Empire loves their damn lists." **Hadvar**: "Ulfric Stormcloak. Jarl of Windhelm." **Ralof**: "It has been an honor, Jarl Ulfric!" **Hadvar**: "Ralof of Riverwood. Lokir of Rorikstead." **Lokir**: "No, I'm not a rebel. You can't do this!" **Captain**: "Halt!" **Lokir**: "You're not going to kill me!" **Captain**: "Archers!" **Captain**: "Anyone else feel like running?" **Hadvar**: "Wait. You there. Step forward. Who are you?"

Character creation

Main article: [Character Creation \(Skyrim\)](#)

Character creation is operationally similar to [Oblivion](#) but incorporated a greater level of detail and customization. The Dragonborn's race, weight, gender, and facial structure can be determined via value sliders. The race and gender of the Dragonborn will occasionally affect how the people of [Skyrim](#) and [beyond](#) react to the them.

Hadvar's comment when he calls the Dragonborn will change based on the race chosen:

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	Race	COM...Hadvar's comment
Home	Altmer	"You're not with the Thalmor Embassy, are you, high elf? No, that can't be right..."
	Argonian	"Are you a relative of one of the Riften dock workers, Argonian?"
Explore	Bosmer	"Not many wood elves would choose to come alone to Skyrim."
	Breton	"You from Daggerfall, Breton? Fleeing from some court intrigue?"
	Dunmer	"Another refugee? Gods really have abandoned your people, dark elf."
Saved	Imperial	"You're a long way from the Imperial City. What're you doing in Skyrim?"
	Khajiit	"You with one of the trade caravans, Khajiit? Your kind always seems to find trouble."
Progress	Nord	"You picked a bad time to come home to Skyrim, kinsman."
	Orsimer	"You from one of the strongholds, Orc? How did you end up here?"
History	Redguard	"What're you doing here, Redguard? You a sellsword? A sailor from Stros M'Kai?"

Utilities

Executions

Hadvar: *"Captain. What should we do? He/She's not on the list."* Captain: *"Forget the list. He/She goes to the block."* Hadvar: *"By your orders, Captain. Follow the Captain, prisoner."* Tullius: *"Ulfric Stormcloak. Some here in Helgen call you a hero. But a hero doesn't use a power like The Voice to murder his king and usurp his throne."* Ulfric: *"*muffled grunts*" Tullius: "You started this war, plunged Skyrim into chaos, and now the Empire is going to put you down, and restore the peace."*

At this point Alduin roars for the first time, drawing the attention of everyone gathered around the execution block, but the soldiers think little of it.

Hadvar: *"What was that?" Tullius: "It's nothing. Carry on."* Captain: *"Yes, General Tullius. Give them their last rites."* Priestess of Arkay: *"As we commend your souls to Aetherius, blessings of the Eight Divines upon you, for you are the salt and earth of Nirn, our beloved..." Stormcloak Soldier: "For the love of Talos, shut up and let's get this over with."* Priestess of Arkay: *"As you wish."* Stormcloak Soldier: *"Come on, I haven't got all morning. My ancestors are smiling at me, Imperials. Can you say the same?"*

[With those last defiant words to Tullius, the Imperial Captain, and the Legionnaires, the Stormcloak is beheaded by the executioner. The Imperial Captain then shoves his lifeless body off to the side of the chopping block]

Stormcloak: *"You Imperial bastards!" Vilod: "Justice!" Ingrid: "Death to the Stormcloaks!" Ralof: "As fearless in death as he was in life."* Captain: *"Next, the [Dragonborn's race]!"*

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Hadvar: *"There it is again. Did you hear that?"* **Captain:** *"I*

said, next prisoner!"

Hadvar: *"To the block, prisoner. Nice and easy."*

Alduin flying in over Helgen.

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The Dragonborn approaches the chopping block. As they kneel down and place their head into position to be sliced off by the headsman's axe, looking up at the headsman as he raises his axe to execute them, Alduin's third roar occurs, and he makes an appearance atop the tower, flying into view from behind the nearby mountains before touching down on the tower and launching his attack, causing the headsman to stumble forward right when he was about to swing his axe down on the Dragonborn's neck.

Tullius: *"What in Oblivion is that?"* **Captain:** *"Sentries! What do you see?"*

Imperial: *"It's in the clouds!"* *[Weapons are heard being drawn as all eyes turn to look at Alduin]* **Stormcloak:** *"Dragon!"* **Alduin:** *[Meteor-shower shout]* **Headsman:** *"Hunh..."* *[Alduin then unleashes his [Unrelenting Force](#) shout, killing the headsman and throwing the Dragonborn away from the chopping block in the process]* **Alduin:** *"Fus... Ro... Dah!"* **Tullius:** *"Don't just stand there! Kill that thing! Guards, get the townspeople to safety!"* **Ralof:** *"Hey, [\[race-dependent comment\]](#). Get up! Come on, the gods won't give us another chance!"*

With the execution halted and the town in chaos, the Dragonborn escapes execution with hands still bound. In the carnage, Ralof calls to them from a nearby watchtower, where he and Ulfric Stormcloak are hiding with several other Stormcloak prisoners.

Ralof: *"This way!"* **Ralof:** *"This way, come on!"* **Ralof:** *"In here!"* **Ralof:** *"Over here!"*

Imperial Soldier: *"What in the [Eight Divines](#) is this thing?!"* **Imperial Soldier:**

"Yeargh!" *(hit by meteor)* **Imperial Soldier:** *"Keep your eyes on it!"* **Imperial**

Soldier: *"How in Oblivion do we kill this thing?!"* **Imperial Soldier:** *"It's still coming!"*

Imperial Soldier: *"By [Ysmir](#)! Nothing kills it!"* **Imperial Soldier:** *"Die! For the love of the gods, die!"*

Once the Dragonborn enters the watchtower, Ralof closes the door and the soldiers recuperate and tend to their wounded. Ulfric Stormcloak removes his gag.

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Ralof: *"Jarl Ulfric! What is that thing? Could the legends be true?"* **Ulfric:** *"Legends don't burn down villages."*

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[Thundering explosion from outside]

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dragon and they'd both be dead..." Ralof: "Let's go! With me, up the tower!"
Stormcloak: *"We just need to move some of these rocks to clear the way!"*

Alduin bashes through the wall next to the staircase as the Dragonborn is ascending it, killing another Stormcloak in the process, then leaves. Ralof follows the Dragonborn and looks out of the hole.

Alduin: *"Yol...Toor...Shul!"* **Ralof:** *"See the inn on the other side? Jump through the roof and keep going! Go! We'll follow when we can!"*

After jumping out of the hole and into the ruins of an adjacent inn, the Dragonborn finds Helgen heavily damaged, with many buildings destroyed and burning. After the Dragonborn runs into the street, an Imperial soldier, **Hadvar**, will tell the Dragonborn to follow him to safety.

Hadvar: *"Haming, you need to get over here. Now! That a boy. You're doing great. Torolf! Gods... Everyone get back!"* **Alduin:** *"Yol...Toor...Shul!"* [Alduin uses his *Fire Breath* to incinerate Torolf, killing him instantly]
Hadvar: *"Still alive, prisoner? Keep close to me if you want to stay that way. Gunnar, take care of the boy. I have to find General Tullius and join their defense."*
Gunnar: *"Gods guide you, Hadvar."* **Hadvar:** *"Stay close to the wall!"*

Alduin will now land on the wall above the Dragonborn. Hadvar will then lead the Dragonborn to the **Helgen Keep**. At the keep's entrance, Ralof catches up.

Alduin: *"Yol...Toor...Shul!"* **Hadvar:** *"Quickly, follow me!"* **Tullius:** *"Hadvar! Into the keep, soldier, we're leaving!"* **Hadvar:** *"It's you and me, prisoner. Stay close!"*
[If the Dragonborn hesitates and stays with the General, his troops, and a dying Vilod...]
Tullius: *"Run, you idiot!"*
[The Dragonborn and Hadvar approach Helgen Keep, only to find Ralof having made it there himself, having broken off from Ulfric and the other Stormcloaks to escape alone]
Hadvar: *"Ralof! You damned traitor. Out of my way!"* **Ralof:** *"We're escaping, Hadvar. You're not stopping us this time."* **Hadvar:** *"Fine. I hope that dragon takes you all to Sovngarde."* **Ralof:** *"You! Come on, into the keep!"* **Hadvar:** *"With me, prisoner. Let's go!"*

At that point, either Hadvar or Ralof must be chosen to accompany the Dragonborn the rest of the way. The choice will create some minor changes in the story during the **Civil War** questline; however, this does not affect the side that can be taken in the war later in the game.

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Ralof: "Through here. Let's go!"

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If Hadvar is followed:

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Hadvar: "Quick, I can cut you loose inside the keep." **Hadvar:** "Come on! We need to get inside!" **Alduin:** "Hin sil fen nahkip bahloki."

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The Dragonborn will still be cut loose regardless of who is followed. As Alduin speaks, he can be seen grabbing one of the Imperial Legionnaire archers in a [Kill Camera](#) finisher, tossing them into the air to leave their body to crash to the ground afterwards.

Progress

Helgen Keep

History

The only main difference at the beginning of the game between following Ralof and following Hadvar is that if Hadvar is followed, the Dragonborn gets light armor, but if Ralof is followed, the Dragonborn gets heavy armor (which is separately obtainable later), but can then double back to where they would have entered the keep with Hadvar to acquire light armor as well.

Utilities

Following Ralof

Upon entering the keep, the Dragonborn and Ralof discover the body of a dead Stormcloak, [Gunjar](#). After freeing the Dragonborn from their bindings, Ralof instructs the Dragonborn to take Gunjar's gear, as he will not be needing it. While it is being equipped, Ralof examines the doors. He discovers one door is locked, and the other cannot be opened from the inside. Luckily, the [Imperial Captain](#) from the executions and an [Imperial](#) soldier will come through and open the door from the other side (if the Dragonborn is seen before the gate is open, the captain will be alert and shout "It's the escaped prisoners!"). Once they open the door, they must be killed in order to recover the key to the other gate from their bodies. Also, a full set of heavy [Imperial Armor](#) can be taken from the Imperial Captain's corpse. The newly opened path leads them down the stairs. As they walk down the hallway, the dragon's activities above will cause the ceiling to fall, forcing them to divert through a door on their left that leads into a store room, where two more Imperial soldiers gathering supplies.

After defeating the soldiers, Ralof advises the Dragonborn to go through the barrels to find potions. There is time for a thorough search of the area and all containers and to become familiar with Skyrim's controls and menus. A search will find a barrel with [potions](#), a [magicka](#) potion over near the table with bread, tankards, and a potion of minor healing. Between the barrel of potions and the cabinet, there is a crate containing four [rock warbler eggs](#), which can be used in [Alchemy](#). Taking any of these things is optional, which means the Dragonborn does not need to take them in order to proceed.

Continuing down, a battle between an Imperial [torturer](#) and his [assistant](#) against two Stormcloaks is discovered. If either Stormcloak survives the combat, the following conversation will be heard: E...

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Regardless of the battle's outcome, Ralof will then look around the room.

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Ralof: "[walks up to the center cage] Wait a second. It looks like there's something in this cage. [pause] Ah, its locked. See if you can get it open with some picks. We'll need that gold when we get out."

Ralof gives 12 picks to pick open the cage, which contains a dead mage who is wearing a **novice hood** and **robes**. Along with this, he has 25 and two potions of minor magicka. Next to him are a few **septs** and a **Sparks spell tome**. The rest of the locked cells can be picked for lockpicking experience. In the armory there are two lockpicks, an **iron shield**, and an **iron mace** and a couple of books. On a table outside the cage is a knapsack containing four lockpicks and some gold. Next to it are *The Book of the Dragonborn* and an **iron dagger**. The torturer who was killed also has a **steel dagger**, the only one in the keep.

Beyond is a hallway lined with cells. One of these cells contains a skeleton, **bone meal**, and a coin purse. After that, a room is entered with prisoners in cages. All of them are deceased, and there are three more skeletons, all of which also carry bone meal, or on rare occasions, may be empty. They may have gold on them as well. In one of the cages, there is a dead Stormcloak wearing **ragged robes**.

Eventually, a natural cave is entered, filled with soldiers guarding it for General Tullius. There are few Imperial soldiers in the cavern, along with another soldier wearing **Imperial Armor**. The archers all are positioned dangerously close to a pool of flammable oil, which can be set on fire using the **Flames** spell. After killing them, any surviving Stormcloak Soldiers will stay behind, waiting for Ulfric Stormcloak, wishing Ralof and the Dragonborn good luck and asking that **Talos** guide them to safety.

Next is a drawbridge that connects to another part of the cave that is not occupied by the Imperials. Shortly after arriving in this cave, Alduin will roar, destroying the bridge behind the Dragonborn. When following Ralof, there is a skeleton near the passage leading towards the cavern that leads to **frostbite spiders**. Near the skeleton is an iron dagger, a potion of minor healing, and a coin purse. The next cavern consists of two to four of the smaller variety of frostbite spiders, plus two larger ones (not to be mistaken for **giant frostbite spiders**) that will drop down from the ceiling. **Frostbite venom** can be collected from their corpses. There are also **Spider Eggs** in the egg sacks and **skeever tails** in the hanging web sacks, as well as some gold or a lockpick or two in the hanging desiccate corpse. Once the spiders are defeated, the Dragonborn and Ralof exit through another passageway.

In the next cave, a potion of health is at the fire at the other side of the water. There is also another iron dagger. The potion cannot be seen from a distance, because it is too close to the fire. After getting the potion, Ralof tells the Dragonborn to stop at the cart, as there is a **bear** on the other side. He suggests **sneaking** by, but he also gives the Dragonborn a **Long Bow** and twelve **iron arrows**. If the Dragonborn chooses to fight the bear, its damage will be reduced by 80% to make the battle easier. In the cart next to the Dragonborn are two bottles of **Alto wine** and

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Beyond the ~~cave~~ is an exit to the cave. Upon exiting, Alduin can be seen flying overhead. Ralof will direct the Dragonborn to his sister, [Gerdur](#), who lives in [Riverwood](#). At this point the Dragonborn can choose to follow Ralof to Riverwood, or split up and find their own way. If the Dragonborn decides to split up, some unique dialogue can be missed. If they choose to follow Ralof, a bandit and three wolves will attack.

Following Hadvar

After entering the keep with Hadvar, he unbinds the Dragonborn and tells them to look for equipment. In the corner of the room there is a warden's chest where an [iron sword](#), [Imperial light armor](#), [Imperial light boots](#), and a Helgen Keep key can be found, in a chest in front of one of the beds an [Imperial light helmet](#) can be found. After opening the door with the key, pulling the chain will open the wooden gate. Behind the gate there are two hostile Stormcloaks. After defeating them there is another door, leading to the stairs. As they walk down the hallway, the dragon's activities above will cause the ceiling to fall, forcing them to divert through a door on their left that leads into a store room, where two more Stormcloaks are gathering supplies.

When the fight is won Hadvar advises the Dragonborn to go through the barrels to find potions. There is time for a thorough search of the area and all containers and to become familiar with Skyrim's controls and menus. A search will find a barrel with [potions](#), a [magicka](#) potion over near the table with bread, tankards, and a potion of minor healing. Between the barrel of potions and the cabinet, there is a crate containing five [rock warbler eggs](#), which can be used in [Alchemy](#). Taking any of these things is optional, which means the Dragonborn does not need to take them in order to proceed.

Going down, there is a torture room, where the [torturer](#) and his [assistant](#) are battling the two Stormcloaks. If the torturer survives, the following dialogue will occur:

Torturer: "You fellows happened along just in time. These boys seemed a bit upset at how I've been entertaining their comrades." **Hadvar:** "Don't you even know what's going on? A dragon is attacking Helgen!" **Torturer:** "A dragon? Please. Don't make up nonsense. [pause] Although, come to think of it, I did hear some odd noises coming from over there." **Hadvar:** "Come with us. We need to get out of here." **Torturer:** "You have no authority over me, boy." **Hadvar:** "Didn't you hear me? I said the keep is under attack!"

If the Torturer's Assistant is alive, he will say at this point: "Forget the old man. I'll come with you." If not, his line is skipped. Either way, the conversation continues:

Hadvar: "Wait a second. Looks like there's something in this cage." **Torturer:** "Don't bother with that. Lost the key ages ago. Poor fellow screamed for weeks." **Hadvar:** "See if you can get it open with some picks. We'll need everything we can get." **Torturer:** "Sure, take all my things. Please." **Hadvar:** "Grab what you can, and let's go." **Torturer:** "There's no way out that way, you know."

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Sparks spell tome. The cage (and other prison doors) can be picked open with the **Lockpicking** skill. In the armory there are two lockpicks, an **iron shield**, and an **iron mace** and a couple of books. On a table outside the cage is a knapsack containing four lockpicks and some gold. Next to the knapsack are *The Book of the Dragonborn* and an **iron dagger**.

Beyond the torture room is a hallway lined with cells. One of these cells contains a skeleton, **bone meal**, and a coin purse. After that, a room is entered with prisoners in cages. All of them are deceased, and there are three more skeletons, all of which also carry bone meal, or on rare occasions, may be empty. They may have gold on them as well. In one of the cages, there is a dead Stormcloak wearing **ragged robes**.

Eventually, a natural cave is entered, filled with about ten more Stormcloaks to kill. Some of them are near a pool of oil which can be set ablaze with the **Flames** spell. If the Torturer's Assistant is still alive at this point, he will stay behind to make sure the Torturer is alright and wish Hadvar and the Dragonborn good luck. Then, a bridge which is activated by a lever nearby must be crossed. After going through the bridge and entering the cave, Alduin will roar, which causes the ceiling above the bridge to collapse.

Now, the Dragonborn only needs to follow the quest marker along with Hadvar. There is a skeleton near the passage leading towards a cavern. Near the skeleton is an iron dagger, a potion of minor healing, and a coin purse. The next cavern consists of two to four of the smaller variety of **frostbite spiders**, plus two larger ones (not to be mistaken for **giant frostbite spiders**) that will drop down from the ceiling. **Frostbite venom** can be collected from their corpses. There are also **Spider Eggs** in the egg sacks and **skeever tails** in the hanging web sacks, as well as some gold or a lockpick or two in the hanging desiccate corpse.

After killing the spiders, exit through another passageway. In the next cave, a potion of health is at the fire at the other side of the water. There is also another iron dagger. The potion cannot be seen from a distance, because it is too close to the fire. After getting the potion, a sleeping **bear** is found. Hadvar gives the Dragonborn a **Long Bow** and twelve **iron arrows**, suggesting either sneaking past or killing the bear. If the Dragonborn chooses to fight the bear, its damage will be reduced by 80% to make the battle easier. In the cart next to the Dragonborn are two bottles of **Alto wine** and a coin purse. In front of the cart, near the skeleton, is an **iron helmet** and a bottle of **Black-Briar Mead**.

After the bear has been dealt with, the two can exit the cave. Upon exiting, Alduin can be seen flying overhead, retreating to parts unknown after completing his rampage of Helgen.

After exiting the cave, Hadvar will direct the Dragonborn to his uncle, **Alvor**, who lives in **Riverwood**. At this point the Dragonborn can choose to follow Hadvar to Riverwood, or split up and find their own way. If the Dragonborn decides to split up, unique dialogue can be missed.

Advantages and Disadvantages

Following **Ralof** (Stormcloaks) grants slightly better **heavy armor** because one of the guards who must be killed is the Imperial Captain from the executions, which means that her Imperial armor

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If the Dragonborn sides with Hadvar (Imperial Legion), the pile of [iron](#) and [steel ingots](#) which spawn next to the workbench outside of [Alvor and Sigrid's house](#) can be taken freely. This gives the Dragonborn a better weapon from the start if they have [Steel Smithing](#). The armor and weapons next to the grindstone and in the basement of his house can also be taken. However, even if the Dragonborn sides with Ralof, all these items can still be acquired if the Dragonborn later assists Alvor in smithing, improving their [disposition](#) with him.

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Journal

Unbound – MQ101	
ID	Journal Entry
150	<i>I have been captured by the Empire and sentenced to death alongside the Stormcloak rebels. We were taken to Helgen, but before I could be executed a dragon appeared and attacked the town. I need to find some way to escape.</i>
160	• Objective 30: Make your way to the Keep • Objective 50: Enter the Keep with Hadvar or Ralof
180	<i>I have been captured by the Empire and sentenced to death alongside the Stormcloak rebels. We were taken to Helgen, but before I could be executed a dragon appeared and attacked the town. I need to find some way to escape.</i>
250	• Objective 100: Escape Helgen
255	Hadvar: • Objective 60: Find some equipment Ralof: • Objective 65: Loot Gunjar's body
315	• Objective 70: (Optional) Search the barrel for potions
390	• Objective 75: (Optional) Attempt to pick the lock to the cage
900	<i>I have escaped both my execution and a dragon attack at Helgen. I now have my freedom to do as I see fit in Skyrim.</i> • Quest complete

Gallery

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Arriving at Helgen.



Arriving at Helgen.



Just off the wagon.



About to be beheaded.



Alduin breathing fire.



Under attack.

Trivia

- When the Dragonborn is forced to decide whether to follow Hadvar or Ralof, if they wait too long, Alduin will land in the courtyard or the tower at Ralof's location and attack with either his Thu'um or his bite.
- During Hadvar and Ralof's "quarrel," Alduin grabs an Imperial with his talons and throws him into the air.
 - If the Dragonborn is an Imperial and uses the **Voice of the Emperor** on an Imperial soldier, talking to them will reveal that his name was **Caius**.
- If the Dragonborn runs fast enough past Hadvar, **Vilod** will not get attacked by Alduin. It is also possible to save **Torolf** in the same manner if the Dragonborn runs fast enough.
- The Dragonborn will always know the **Flames** and **Healing** spells, and depending on their race, other spells will also be known:
 - **Altmer** will also know **Fury**.
 - **Bretons** will also know **Conjure Familiar**.
 - **Dunmer** will also know **Sparks**.
- If the Dragonborn clips through the walls in the barracks in the Keep, they may fall and end up in the storeroom. The two enemies there may be absent, and the Torturer, his assistant, and the two Stormcloak soldiers in the torture room may not be hostile to each other. The five spiders and the bear in the cave, however, are unaffected, and will remain hostile.
- Be warned, however, that once Hadvar or Ralof are freed from the key-locked gate, the two enemies in the storeroom will return, and the hostilities between the torturer, **ELD...** torturer's assistant, and the two Stormcloak soldiers in the torture room will return.

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- If the ~~Dragon~~ Dragonborn takes too long to advance up the tower, Ralof and Ulfric will tell them to hurry up. Likewise, Hadvar and General Tullius will do the same if the Dragonborn takes too long to advance to the Keep.
- The Torturer and his assistant can be killed with no repercussions, even if the Dragonborn follows Hadvar.
- Hadvar and Ralof are considered essential characters during this quest, and they can be exploited to level up the Dragonborn's [One-Handed](#), [Two-Handed](#), [Archery](#), [Sneak](#), and [Destruction](#) skills. They cannot be pickpocketed, though.
- Hadvar and Ralof will become hostile towards the Dragonborn if they cast [Fury](#) on them, despite not becoming hostile due to any other form of attack.
- When the Dragonborn advances to the Keep, the locations to nearby [Bonechill Passage](#), [Fort Neugrad](#), [Greywater Grotto](#), [Orphan Rock](#), and [South Skybound Watch](#) will appear on the Dragonborn's compass, though the Dragonborn cannot discover them yet.
- This is the only quest in the game where an [Imperial Mage](#) can be seen; [originally](#) they were also meant to appear as soldiers in the [Skyrim Civil War](#), but those mages were cut.
- The Dragonborn's starting carry weight limit is 300 by default. It will be reduced to 150 if [Survival Mode](#) is active.
- Even if the bear is killed with a sneak attack, Hadvar will say "Not the sneaking type, eh?" or Ralof will say "Sneaking is highly overrated, eh?"
- If Hadvar is followed, the first tutorial message after the Dragonborn's bindings are cut will say "Press [activate] to open containers." However, if Ralof is followed, it will instead say "Press [activate] to loot bodies."
- After escaping from Helgen, it can be re-entered immediately. If the Dragonborn re-enters the Keep, and if there were any Stormcloak/Imperial soldiers not killed during the first run, they will still be inside, but will not be hostile.
- The game will always start on the 17th of Last Seed 4E 201, making this the only quest with a fixed date. The day of the week can vary, however.
 - If a game has not been previously loaded, the day of the week will be Sundas.
 - If a save game is loaded, and then a new game is started, then the day of the week the game will start will be the same as the previously loaded game.
- Choosing between Hadvar or Ralof has no major practical difference and does not prevent the Dragonborn from completing either [Civil War](#) questline. The only difference is the loot that is encountered in Helgen Keep and gift items from either Alvor or Hod.

Bugs

This section contains [bugs](#) related to Unbound. Before adding a bug to this list, consider the following:

1. Please **reload an old save** to confirm if the bug is still happening.
2. If the bug is still occurring, please post the bug report with the appropriate system template:

PC / MAC / 360 / XB1 / XS / PS3 / PS4 / PS5 / Android / IOS / NX / NX2

, depending on which platform(s) the bug has been encountered on.
3. Be descriptive when listing the bug and fixes, but avoid having conversations in the description and/or using first-person anecdotes: such discussions belong on the appropriate [forum board](#).

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